

Reading Review: Hume

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Overview of the Text

I think the purpose of this text is to give short bits of advice on how to make a good speech. These advice are not thorough and deep and profound, but somewhat superficial and short. Ultimately, I believe that a true speech cannot be good by following all this advice, but rather the true spirit of the speech is the deep character of the speaker. The ethos is not talked about in this book. But the author conveyed some straightforward points on what makes a speech engaging and powerful.

Key Points

- 1) Power. Power is what makes a speech good. We need to speak strongly, and deliver a message that grabs attention and is different from all other messages. It needs to make the listener in awe and remember the speech for a while. Every chapter begins with "Power." The powerful quotes and examples of speeches stood out to me.
- 2) Appearance. Appearance must look good in order to make people want to listen. If you look very good, the speech will sound good. He goes into depth about the appearance of Margaret Thatcher and many other prominent women and men - this is what stood out to me.

Personal Application

This text is not a Christian text, which is so interesting as to why the professor chose this text. How can a non-Christian text affect my Christian walk? It is an interesting question. I personally realized that Christ and the Spirit of the speech is

more important than any technique that this book speaks of. I personally found this book to be extremely pedantic and boring after reading for a while because it seems like it is talking about the same superficial things. The Bible and the true sermons that come from the Spirit can not be forced or manufactured with artificial techniques. This book affected my walk with the Lord in confirming that it is not me who can make a good speech, but it is the Lord.

It is this truth that the Lord is reminding me everyday - that it is not my strength or ability that will make me a pastor or a good pastor, it is the Spirit of the Lord, which is upon me. The Lord needs to humble me and show me that I can do nothing without him. I am weak. I am pitiful. I am actually bad - sinful. I don't deserve anything. I deserve punishment. And when I deliver a speech, I need to have the humility and honest love that God gives me for Him and for the audience.

I personally am not preaching to some crowd to make some political statement - I am making a sermon to exult in and exalt Christ. I need to be conscious of how I do this, and follow all the artificial things that I need to do, but other than that, it is the Spirit of the Lord that will guide the sermon and the Holy Spirit that will convict people of sin - not me.

I think there are many great men who are not pastors in this world. All sorts of American Presidents were named in this book. But I see none of them truly as great as the great pastors of America. The great pastors of America spoke to the core of what is important, which American Presidents generally speak fluff.

What I realized is that I don't need to worry about what kind of car I will drive, and how much money I will have, and even whether I will give a good sermon.